Filling company registration forms from VCFO Suite

Project summary for SBC · 5 November 2026 · Status: built and tested offline, not yet used on a real filing

In short. SBC staff type every new company's details twice: once in VCFO Suite, the firm's own compliance app, and again on the government's MCA portal. We built **VCFO Assist**, a Chrome extension that copies the data from Suite into the portal forms while a person stays logged in and in charge. The software fills and checks. People still log in, submit, sign and pay. It has not run on the live logged-in portal, and it must not until a company secretary (CS) gives a written opinion.

MCA: Ministry of Corporate Affairs. **SPICe+:** the incorporation form; Part A reserves the name, Part B incorporates. **SRN:** the portal's filing reference. **OTP:** one-time passcode. **CS:** company secretary. **MOA, AOA:** memorandum and articles.

The problem

- Double entry costs time and can put errors into a statutory filing.
- The first aim was full automation, with no person. That is not possible within the legal rules set out below.
- We found no public MCA filing API, so tools work through the portal's web pages.
- Login needs a captcha and an OTP. Each signer must sign with their own digital signature.
- Deadlines are strict: upload within 15 days of the SRN, then pay within 7 days.

The solution

- Staff enter data once, in Suite. Assist fills SPICe+ Part A and Part B from it.
- Assist works inside the person's own browser session and stores no MCA password, OTP or signature PIN.
- It stops if the portal form has changed, so it does not fill a form it does not recognise.
- Suite reads the portal's PDF and the signed PDF, and refuses a wrong signer or an out-of-date copy.
- Suite tracks each filing's stage and deadlines, and keeps an audit log.

How a filing works

Software does the step. Person must do it; the software cannot. Both share it. Steps 7 to 9 are for Part B only.

1	Person	Enters the client's data once in Suite. Suite lists anything missing.
2	Person	Saves the reference of the written CS approval. Assist does not start without one.
3	Person	Logs in to the MCA portal and completes the captcha and OTP.
4	Software	Compares the live form with the stored copy. If it has changed, the run stops and names the fields.
5	Software	Fills the form, attaches the board resolution and utility bill, reads values back, lists differences, stops.
6	Person	Reviews and submits the web form. The portal gives an SRN and a PDF. The person types in the SRN.
7	Both	A person uploads the portal PDF to Suite. Suite compares its text with Suite's data. Staff approve the review.
8	Person	Each signer signs with their own digital signature. Staff can have Suite email each signer the PDF.
9	Software	Suite refuses the signed PDF unless the signature is valid, the signer known and the text current.
10	Both	Assist places the signed file for upload. A person completes the upload, pays and does the final submit.
11	Software	Suite tracks the stage and warns the lead in the app when an upload or payment date is near.

What the market does

Tool	How it works, as the vendor shows it	SPICe+ shown?
ComplyRelax	Cloud app plus a Windows agent. The user adds an MCA login. OTP handling unclear.	Not confirmed
Gen CompLaw	Desktop software holding MCA IDs; saves forms. The user previews and submits.	Yes
Leagully	Cloud app that acts in the background with stored logins. The user types the OTP.	Not seen
CSTrax, AutoROC	Prepare the data. The user submits or types it on the portal.	Not seen / No

Vendor statements, not tested by us. We found no MCA approval for any of them, and being on sale does not prove a method lawful.

The routes we weighed

Route	Decision	Why
Own extension, user's own session	Built	Suite stays the one data source, with no credentials held. Can break when the portal changes.
Buy a vendor tool	Compare	Double entry stays unless the vendor accepts Suite's data. Vendor holds logins. Demos still to come.
Own robot with stored logins	On hold	Closest to full automation, but needs credential custody and clear legal approval.
Calling private portal endpoints	Rejected	Undocumented, and most captured requests appear to carry encrypted data.
Official MCA filing API	Ask MCA	The best result if one exists. We found none. A draft letter awaits CS review.

The legal line

The project owner's rule is that nothing may be illegal. This document is not legal advice; a written CS or counsel opinion decides. If the opinion is unclear, the method counts as prohibited.

Allowed now	Entering data by hand on the portal. Suite checks that do not touch the portal.
Needs CS approval	Assist on the live portal, any live test, any software submit, any vendor or agent holding a login.
Prohibited	Bypassing a captcha or OTP. Signing for a signer. Using another person's login or signature without valid authority. False or test data on the portal. Calling private portal endpoints. A professional certifying without checks.

The software checks only that an approval reference was saved, not that the opinion exists or what it says.

Where it stands

Done	Extension and Suite work are built. Extension: 13 unit tests pass, plus a browser run on saved copies of MCA pages. Suite: 4,410 tests pass and the type check is clean.
Not shipped	The code is not committed or deployed. Production needs one database change before release.
Not proven	Nobody knows yet if it works on the real portal: the offline run removed page scripts and used a stand-in for Suite. Time saved is unmeasured: the plan put timed filings, vendor demos and the CS opinion before any build, and the owner chose to build first.

Known limits and open issues

- **Part B is partly covered.** 610 of its 1,110 fields are mapped. The other 500 are only sorted into proposed groups. 50 director and subscriber row fields stay manual until Part B is captured again.
- **Some files stay manual:** the MOA and AOA (Suite holds only unsigned Word drafts), and the portal PDF upload to Suite.
- **The signature check is partial.** Suite does not check the chain to India's CCA root, so a self-made certificate passes there. Real MCA PDFs and signing tools are untried; a tool that re-saves the PDF may be wrongly refused.
- **Other gaps.** Signer emails and the deadline alert job have not run live. Any staff member on the engagement, including a lead, can approve the PDF review.
- **Past portal contact.** The field maps come from a September 2026 capture, where scripts opened MCA forms in a logged-in session. The log records two clicks on a control named Submit; who clicked and what was filed is not established. This goes to the CS first. Also, three early test runs this month may have opened the public MCA site, with no login or filling, before that access was blocked.

What happens next

1	Secure the September capture folder, and send the drafted request to the CS, including the capture facts.	Owner
2	Time three filings as a baseline, and hold vendor demos for comparison.	Owner, lead
3	After written approval, run Part A on one real planned filing with true data, and stop before submit.	Developer, lead
4	Capture Part B with filled rows, and confirm the remaining field mappings.	Developer
5	File three real companies with a CS watching. Release only if all three receive a certificate of incorporation.	CS, lead